ship being sunk during an armed confrontation between Irgun and the IDF that left a number of Irgun members and IDF troops dead.

The issue of the *Altalena* also became a factor for the man entrusted with the difficult task of overseeing the ceasefire, Swedish UN mediator Count Folke Bernadotte. Bernadotte was given the task by the UN of finding "a peaceful adjustment of the future situation of Palestine." In any circumstances, that would have been an extremely challenging task, but in the midst of a war, it proved impossible. Instead, Bernadotte was reduced to highlighting breaches of the ceasefire, including the clumsy attempt to bring in the freighter *Altalena* and the refusal of forces from Egypt and the Arab Legion to allow humanitarian relief supplies to reach Jewish settlements and towns.

Bernadotte did find the time to propose a new scheme of settlement—one that was calculated to appeal to the Arab nations that had previously rejected partition proposals. He visited Egypt, Lebanon, Jordan as well as Tel Aviv before developing his new proposal. This proposal retained the idea of partitioning Palestine but with a unique twist: Jerusalem, despite its significant Jewish population, would be placed under Arab jurisdiction. Additionally, the important ports of Haifa and Lydda (located within the Israeli zone) would become free ports, and the Negev, a desert region, would fall under Arab control. Furthermore, the Israelis would be required to adhere to strict limits on immigration.

One controversial part of the plan proposed by Bernadotte was that he suggested that Palestine should also enter a union with Jordan, "comprising two Members, one Arab and one Jewish." Each member would have full control over its own affairs, including its foreign relations. While this proposal was eagerly accepted by King Abdullah of Jordan, it was rejected by the other Arab nations involved in the war, which were almost as suspicious of Jordanian territorial ambitions as they were of the new State of Israel.

To many Israelis, now with growing confidence in the IDF, there seemed no reason even to consider such a proposal, particularly when it involved accepting limits on immigration and the loss of Jerusalem. On the Arab side, there was even less enthusiasm for the new proposal, particularly because it seemed to favor Jordan. The 28-day ceasefire would expire on July 9, and rather than seriously considering the proposed peace plan, both sides used this pause in